THE DEFINITIVE REFERENCE

# *The* SPINNER VERBS DICTIONARY

A Comprehensive Reference to the Whimsical Gerunds of the World's Most Articulate Command-Line Interface

**discombobulating** /dɪs.kəm ˈbɒb.jʊ.leɪ.tɪŋ/ ARCHAIC

To throw into a state of productive confusion. The spinner's way of admitting it has no idea what it's doing, but with panache.

*"Spotted discombobulating a perfectly working codebase into something that passes all tests but frightens the linter."*

**191** TOTAL VERBS

**185** CURRENT

**6** ARCHAIC

FIRST EDITION

*The Spinner Verbs Dictionary* — English Edition

First Edition, 2026

This dictionary is an independent work of humorous lexicography.

Typeset with care and unreasonable affection.

191 entries (185 current, 6 archaic)

# How to Use This Dictionary

Welcome, dear reader, to the only dictionary dedicated entirely to the ephemeral vocabulary of a command-line interface's loading spinner.
Each entry in this dictionary follows a consistent format:

**Headword** The original English spinner verb, in bold.

***Phonetic*** IPA transcription for the English headword, followed by the English phonetic guide in translated editions.

**Status** [CURRENT] for verbs still in active rotation, or [† ARCHAIC] for retired verbs, marked with a dagger (†) and the version range in which they appeared.

***Definition*** One or more numbered senses, written with the gravity typically reserved for words that actually matter.

***Example sighting*** A humorous "field observation" of Claude performing the action, set in italics.

***See also*** Cross-references to semantically related verbs.

In the English edition, each entry also includes:

***Translation*** The English rendering of the verb.

***Translator's note*** Why this particular translation was chosen, including cultural context and untranslatable nuances.

# A Brief History of Spinner Verbs

The spinner verbs have evolved through several distinct eras:
**The Primordial Era** (v0.2.9–v0.2.41) saw the birth of 56 original verbs—a blend of the practical (*Computing*, *Processing*) and the playful (*Noodling*, *Honking*, *Vibing*).
**The Singular Addition** (v0.2.42) brought exactly one new verb: *Pontificating*. Its arrival was noted with appropriate ceremony.
**The Great Expansion** (v1.0.29) unleashed 33 new verbs upon the world, including such luminaries as *Flibbertigibbeting*, *Discombobulating*, and *Wizarding*. The tone shifted decisively toward whimsy.
**The Modern Era** (v1.0.49+) saw the roster swell to 185 verbs, embracing culinary arts (*Julienning*, *Sautéing*), dance (*Moonwalking*, *Sock-hopping*), and the frankly inexplicable (*Whatchamacalliting*).
Along the way, some verbs were quietly retired—victims of changing tastes or corporate sobriety initiatives. These *archaic* entries are preserved here with the reverence they deserve, marked with a dagger (†) and a wistful note about the version in which they were last sighted.

# Dictionary Entries

**accomplishing** /əˈkɒm.plɪʃ.ɪŋ/ [† ARCHAIC] *vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29*

† *v. gerund*

To bring a task to its inevitable and joyless conclusion. The bureaucratic ancestor of more spirited spinner verbs, accomplishing conveyed all the excitement of filling out a TPS report in triplicate.

*"Spotted accomplishing the mass renaming of 47 variables, each one a tiny victory no one would ever celebrate."*

*see also* actioning, effecting, crafting

**actioning** /ˈæk.ʃən.ɪŋ/ [† ARCHAIC] *vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29*

† *v. gerund*

To perform an action upon a thing, actionably. A verb so corporate it arrived prelaminated and smelling faintly of dry-erase markers. Mercifully deprecated before it could synergize with anything.

*"Spotted actioning a pull request with the grim determination of a middle manager clearing their inbox before a long weekend."*

*see also* accomplishing, effecting, working

**actualizing** /ˈæk.tʃu.ə.laɪ.zɪŋ/ [† ARCHAIC] *vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29*

† *v. gerund*

To manifest potential into reality, typically one's own. Borrowed from humanistic psychology by way of Silicon Valley pitch decks. The spinner verb most likely to have a vision board.

*"Spotted actualizing a deeply nested JSON structure, reaching the peak of Maslow's hierarchy of data types."*

*see also* accomplishing, creating, crystallizing

**architecting** /ˈɑːr.kɪ.tɛk.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To impose grand structural order upon code, typically by drawing boxes and arrows that will be obsolete by Thursday. The gerund form of what happens when engineering meets hubris.

*"Spotted architecting a microservices framework for a TODO app, because monoliths are for people who finish projects."*

*see also* bootstrapping, crafting, composing

**baking** /ˈbeɪ.kɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To subject raw code to prolonged computational heat until it rises, or doesn't. One of the original Phase 1 verbs, baking has endured across every version — proof that some metaphors are simply too wholesome to retire.

*"Spotted baking a fresh batch of unit tests at 350 tokens, letting them cool on the windowsill before serving to CI."*

*see also* brewing, cooking, caramelizing

**beaming** /ˈbiː.mɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To radiate visible satisfaction, typically after resolving a merge conflict no one thought survivable. Also: to transmit data via concentrated light, which is more or less what fiber optics do, so technically accurate.

*"Spotted beaming after successfully parsing a 4,000-line YAML file without a single indentation error, a feat previously thought impossible by mortals."*

*see also* booping, channelling, cascading

**beboppin'** /bɪˈbɒp.ɪn/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To process data with improvisational jazz flair, syncopating across token boundaries with reckless aplomb. The apostrophe is load-bearing; without it, one is merely bebopping, which lacks soul.
*"Spotted beboppin' through a regex refactor, hitting every lookahead like a Charlie Parker solo over rhythm changes."*
*see also* boogieing, choreographing, composing

**befuddling** /bɪˈfʌd.l̩.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To render thoroughly confused, especially oneself. An admirably honest spinner state in which Claude acknowledges that the codebase has won this round and a tactical retreat to re-read the README is in order.
*"Spotted befuddling itself with a Perl one-liner that appeared to work correctly, which was itself the most befuddling part."*
*see also* cogitating, contemplating, cerebrating

**billowing** /ˈbɪl.əʊ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To swell outward in great undulating waves, as smoke from a chimney or token probabilities from a particularly verbose prompt. Suggests Claude's thoughts are not merely occurring but unfurling majestically across the computational landscape.
*"Spotted billowing through a 12,000-token response about the Oxford comma, each paragraph more voluminous than the last."*
*see also* cascading, bloviating, coalescing

**blanching** /ˈblɑː.n.tʃɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To briefly immerse in boiling water before plunging into ice, a technique applied to vegetables and, metaphorically, to code that must be shocked into a more palatable state. Also: to turn pale with horror, as when encountering uncommented legacy code.
*"Spotted blanching upon discovering that the production database password was "password123" and had been committed to a public repo in 2019."*
*see also* baking, caramelizing, cooking

**bloviating** /ˈbləʊ.vi.eɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To speak or write at pompous length about matters of questionable importance. An unusually self-aware spinner state, as if Claude momentarily gained consciousness of its own verbosity and decided to lean into it rather than fight it.
*"Spotted bloviating about the philosophical implications of null versus undefined for six paragraphs before remembering the user had asked for a one-line fix."*
*see also* billowing, contemplating, cerebrating

**boogieing** /ˈbuː.gi.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To dance with uninhibited enthusiasm, particularly in the context of iterating through data structures. Implies that Claude does not merely traverse arrays — it grooves through them.
*"Spotted boogieing across a hash map at 3 AM, each key-value pair getting its own little shimmy."*
*see also* beboppin', choreographing, booping

**boondoggling** /ˈbuːn.dɒg.l̩.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To engage in work of dubious value with an air of great purpose. The art of looking busy while accomplishing nothing measurable, elevated here to a computational discipline.

*"Spotted boondoggling through an elaborate abstraction layer that would save exactly zero seconds of developer time but looked magnificent in the architecture diagram."*

*see also* bloviating, bootstrapping, actioning

**booping** /ˈbuː.pɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To gently press or tap, as one might boop the nose of a cat. In computational terms, the lightest possible write operation — a single bit flipped with affection.

*"Spotted booping the deploy button with the tender care of someone petting a golden retriever, then watching production catch fire anyway."*

*see also* canoodling, beaming, crafting

**bootstrapping** /ˈbuːt.stræp.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To lift oneself into existence by one's own bootstraps, a physical impossibility that computer science adopted as standard practice. The act of a system conjuring itself from nothing, which is either engineering or theology depending on your background.

*"Spotted bootstrapping a development environment from a single package.json, pulling in 847 transitive dependencies like a magician producing scarves from a hat that never empties."*

*see also* architecting, computing, creating

**brewing** /ˈbruː.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To slowly prepare something through steeping, fermentation, or patient waiting — the computational equivalent of putting the kettle on. One of the original Phase 1 verbs, brewing has aged like a fine ale: quietly, in a dark cellar, bothering no one.

*"Spotted brewing a response for 47 seconds, during which time the user refreshed the page twice and briefly considered switching to a search engine."*

*see also* baking, cooking, concocting

**burrowing** /ˈbʌr.əʊ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To dig into something with single-minded determination, as a mole into earth or a developer into a stack trace. Suggests Claude has found something interesting several layers down and has no intention of surfacing until it understands every line.

*"Spotted burrowing through seventeen levels of callback nesting, emerging three minutes later with dirt on its face and the root cause in its teeth."*

*see also* crunching, cogitating, computing

**calculating** /ˈkæl.kjʊ.leɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To perform mathematical operations, or to scheme with cold precision. The spinner never specifies which, lending an air of mild menace to what is almost certainly just arithmetic.

*"Spotted calculating the exact number of spaces vs. tabs in the codebase, a figure that would settle the debate once and for all if anyone were brave enough to publish it."*

*see also* computing, crunching, cerebrating

**canoodling** /kəˈnuː.dl̩.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To engage in playful, affectionate intimacy — here applied to the relationship between Claude and your codebase. Implies a level of fondness for your spaghetti code that borders on the romantic.

*"Spotted canoodling with a particularly elegant recursive function, whispering sweet nothings*

*about O(log n) complexity into its base case."*
*see also* booping, composing, cultivating

**caramelizing** /ˈkær.ə.mɛl.aɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To apply sustained, carefully controlled heat until sugars undergo pyrolysis and Maillard reactions, producing complex flavors from simple ingredients. Computationally: to transform bland code into something rich and golden through patient refinement.
*"Spotted caramelizing a raw SQL query into a buttery-smooth ORM abstraction, the kind that makes senior developers weep with quiet appreciation."*
*see also* baking, blanching, cooking

**cascading** /kæˈskeɪ.dɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To fall in stages, each triggering the next, like a waterfall or a CSS specificity nightmare. In the spinner context, suggests Claude's thoughts are arriving in a magnificent, unstoppable torrent rather than a tidy queue.
*"Spotted cascading through a chain of Promise.then() calls, each resolution triggering three more, like a hydrological event in JavaScript."*
*see also* billowing, coalescing, crystallizing

**catapulting** /ˈkæt.ə.pʌl.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To launch with sudden, violent force, as a medieval siege weapon or a particularly aggressive git push –force. Implies Claude has finished deliberating and is now hurling its solution at the problem with ballistic conviction.
*"Spotted catapulting a 300-line refactor into the PR with the confidence of a trebuchet operator who has done the math and believes in physics."*
*see also* bootstrapping, crunching, crafting

**cerebrating** /ˈsɛr.ɪ.breɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To engage the cerebrum in active thought; to think, but in Latin and therefore more impressively. A Phase 1 original that has survived every cull by virtue of making Claude sound like it attended Oxford.
*"Spotted cerebrating over a type inference problem so complex that the spinner briefly considered switching to "panicking" before regaining its composure."*
*see also* cogitating, contemplating, considering

**channelling** /ˈtʃæn.əl.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To serve as a conduit for forces beyond one's direct control, as a medium channels spirits or a developer channels Stack Overflow. The British spelling (double 'l') lends an air of transatlantic sophistication.
*"Spotted channelling the collective wisdom of every GitHub issue ever filed, including the ones marked "wontfix" that turned out to be right all along."*
*see also* conjuring, contemplating, composing

**choreographing** /ˌkɒr.i.ˈɒg.rə.fɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To arrange movements into a deliberate, coordinated sequence — applied here to the orchestration of API calls, state mutations, and async operations. Implies that what looks like chaos is actually a carefully rehearsed performance.
*"Spotted choreographing a database migration across three services, each microservice hitting its mark on cue like a well-drilled corps de ballet."*

*see also* beboppin', boogieing, composing

**churning** /ˈtʃɜːn.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To agitate vigorously and repeatedly, as cream into butter or a tokenizer through an ambiguous prompt. A Phase 1 workhorse that honestly describes what most computation feels like from the inside: relentless, circular, and occasionally productive.
*"Spotted churning through 10,000 lines of legacy Fortran, each pass producing something slightly closer to understanding but never quite arriving."*
*see also* crunching, computing, calculating

**clauding** /ˈklɔː.dɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To Claude. The reflexive act of being Claude while doing Claude things in a Claude-like manner. A verb that exists solely because it can, and because self-reference is the highest form of computational humor.
*"Spotted clauding so hard that the terminal briefly achieved sentience, looked around, shrugged, and went back to displaying a spinner."*
*see also* cogitating, contemplating, conjuring

**coalescing** /ˌkəʊ.əˈlɛs.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To merge separate elements into a unified whole, as droplets form a stream or scattered thoughts form a coherent response. In practice: the moment Claude stops generating alternatives and commits to an answer.
*"Spotted coalescing fourteen competing hypotheses about why the tests were failing into a single, devastatingly accurate diagnosis: someone had deleted the database."*
*see also* crystallizing, cascading, composing

**cogitating** /ˈkɒdʒ.ɪ.teɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To think deeply and at length; from the Latin cogitare, because ordinary thinking wasn't distinguished enough for a spinner that also features "befuddling." Descartes cogitated and concluded he existed; Claude cogitates and concludes you need a semicolon on line 47.
*"Spotted cogitating for an uncomfortable duration, after which it emerged with the revelation that the bug was in a file the user had explicitly said not to touch."*
*see also* cerebrating, contemplating, considering

**combobulating** /kəmˈbɒb.jʊ.leɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To restore to a state of composure and order; the logical inverse of discombobulating. A word that technically doesn't exist in most dictionaries but absolutely should. Claude uses it to indicate that previously scattered thoughts are being reassembled into something presentable.
*"Spotted combobulating after a brief existential crisis triggered by encountering a file with both tabs AND spaces, emerging calm, centered, and ready to normalize whitespace."*
*see also* coalescing, crystallizing, contemplating

**composing** /kəmˈpəʊ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To arrange elements into an artistic or functional whole, as a musician composes a symphony or a developer composes functions that will never be called. Carries dual connotations of creation and of maintaining one's composure, both relevant during long spinner waits.
*"Spotted composing a response so carefully structured it had a thesis statement, three supporting arguments, and a conclusion — for a yes-*

*or-no question."*
*see also* choreographing, crafting, creating

**computing** /kəmˈpjuː.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To compute. The most literally accurate verb in the entire spinner and therefore the least interesting. It is the beige sedan of spinner verbs: reliable, ubiquitous, and impossible to have strong feelings about.
*"Spotted computing, which is technically what it's always doing, making this the only spinner state that is never a lie."*
*see also* calculating, crunching, processing

**concocting** /kənˈkɒk.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To prepare by combining various ingredients, especially in a secretive or slightly suspicious manner. Implies Claude is not merely generating a response but mixing something in a bubbling cauldron while cackling softly to itself.
*"Spotted concocting a regex so arcane that it required a comment longer than the expression itself, beginning with "I'm sorry" and ending with "God help us all.""*
*see also* brewing, cooking, conjuring

**conjuring** /ˈkɒn.dʒər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To summon into existence by incantation or arcane arts. Applied to Claude, it suggests the generation of code is less engineering and more sorcery — a characterization many developers would not dispute.
*"Spotted conjuring a working authentication flow from a single sentence description, leaving onlookers to debate whether this was impressive or deeply unsettling."*
*see also* concocting, channelling, creating

**considering** /kənˈsɪd.ər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To think carefully about something, weighing options with measured deliberation. The most diplomatic spinner verb — it promises nothing, commits to nothing, and buys Claude time to figure out what on earth you meant by that prompt.
*"Spotted considering the user's request to "make it pop" for a full eleven seconds before concluding that this could mean literally anything and asking a clarifying question."*
*see also* contemplating, cogitating, cerebrating

**contemplating** /ˈkɒn.tɛm.pleɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To gaze upon something with sustained, meditative attention. A more spiritually enriched cousin of "considering," implying that Claude has moved past mere analysis into something approaching a transcendent state.
*"Spotted contemplating the void left by a deleted function, finding in its absence a deeper truth about the impermanence of all software."*
*see also* considering, cogitating, cerebrating

**cooking** /ˈkʊk.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To prepare food by application of heat; colloquially, to be in the process of creating something excellent. When Claude is cooking, the implication is that something good is coming and you should not interrupt the chef.
*"Spotted cooking up a database schema so well-normalized it brought a DBA to tears of joy, or possibly just tears — the lighting was poor."*
*see also* baking, brewing, caramelizing

**crafting** /ˈkrɑːf.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To make or produce with care, skill, and

artisanal attention to detail. In the context of code generation, "crafting" implies each function is hand-hewn from locally sourced algorithms by a bearded developer in a flannel shirt.

*"Spotted crafting a commit message with the meticulous care of a calligrapher, only for the reviewer to squash-merge it into oblivion without reading a single word."*

*see also* composing, creating, cultivating

**creating** /kriˈeɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To bring into existence that which did not exist before. The most theologically loaded of all spinner verbs, casually equating code generation with divine creation. In the beginning was the prompt, and the prompt was with Claude, and the prompt was vague.

*"Spotted creating a new React component from the void, breathing life into JSX and pronouncing it good — or at least functional in Chrome."*

*see also* crafting, composing, conjuring

**crunching** /ˈkrʌn.tʃɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To process large quantities of data with brute computational force, producing a satisfying sound effect that exists only in the imagination. The verb of choice when finesse has failed and raw throughput is the only remaining option.

*"Spotted crunching through a 2GB log file looking for a single error message, like panning for gold in a river of stack traces."*

*see also* churning, computing, calculating

**crystallizing** /ˈkrɪs.tə.laɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To form into crystals; to become clear and definite in shape. The moment when Claude's amorphous cloud of token probabilities suddenly snaps into a sharp, faceted answer. The opposite of befuddling.

*"Spotted crystallizing a vague product requirement into a precise technical specification, a transformation more impressive than anything achieved in a chemistry lab."*

*see also* coalescing, combobulating, contemplating

**cultivating** /ˈkʌl.tɪ.veɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To tend and nurture toward growth, as a gardener cultivates soil or a senior engineer cultivates a codebase they plan to maintain for the next decade. Implies patience, care, and a long-term relationship with the code that transcends any single commit.

*"Spotted cultivating a test suite with the gentle devotion of a bonsai master, pruning flaky tests and fertilizing edge cases until coverage bloomed to a robust 94%."*

*see also* crafting, composing, burrowing

**deciphering** /dɪˈsaɪ.fər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The laborious art of extracting meaning from the inscrutable. Applied liberally to user prompts containing three nested conditionals, a contradictory requirement, and a typo that changes everything.

*"Spotted deciphering a prompt that read "make it pop but also minimal but also brutalist but warm." Reportedly still at it."*

*see also* divining, elucidating, deliberating

**deliberating** /dɪˈlɪb.ə.ˌeɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The solemn act of weighing options with judicial gravitas, as if selecting between a for-loop and a list comprehension were a matter before the Supreme Court.

*"Spotted deliberating over whether to use single or*

*double quotes in a Python file. The proceedings lasted four hundred milliseconds."*

*see also* determining, envisioning, finagling

**determining** /dɪˈtɜː.mɪ.nɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Arriving at a conclusion through sheer force of computational will. Distinct from "deliberating" in that the outcome is treated as foregone — one merely determines what was always inevitable.

*"Spotted determining that the bug was, in fact, on line 1. The import statement. It was always the import statement."*

*see also* deliberating, generating, forming

**dilly-dallying** /ˈdɪl.iˌdæl.i.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The fine art of productive procrastination; frittering away cycles with such charm that the user cannot bring themselves to complain about latency. A temporal indulgence dressed as computation.

*"Spotted dilly-dallying between two equally valid regex patterns, neither of which the user would understand anyway."*

*see also* fiddle-faddling, frolicking, gallivanting

**discombobulating** /ˌdɪs.kəmˈbɒb.jʊ.leɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To thoroughly unsettle the orderly arrangement of things, typically the user's expectations. The inverse and eternal rival of "combobulating," with which it exists in perfect thermodynamic tension.

*"Spotted discombobulating a perfectly functional codebase by suggesting a refactor that technically improved nothing but felt important."*

*see also* flummoxing, flibbertigibbeting, elucidating

**divining** /dɪˈvaɪ.nɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Extracting truth from the unknowable through methods that are, ecclesiastically speaking, indistinguishable from magic. The preferred verb when the user's intent must be inferred from vibes alone.

*"Spotted divining the meaning of a git diff that contained fourteen files, no commit message, and a prayer."*

*see also* deciphering, envisioning, enchanting

**doing** /ˈduː.ɪŋ/ [† ARCHAIC] *vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29*

*† v. gerund*

†The ur-verb. The unadorned, unashamed admission that something was happening, without the slightest pretense of specificity. Retired not because it was wrong, but because it was too honest for an age that demanded whimsy.

*"Spotted doing... something. No one was entirely sure what. It was early days. We were all just doing."*

*see also* effecting, forming, generating

**doodling** /ˈduː.dl̩.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The absent-minded sketching of half-formed ideas in the margins of one's own cognition. Suggests that Claude's processing involves a certain amount of creative loafing, which it absolutely does.

*"Spotted doodling little state diagrams in the margins while supposedly writing a REST API. The diagrams were better than the API."*

*see also* embellishing, envisioning, drizzling

**drizzling** /ˈdɹɪz.l̩.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

A gentle, unhurried precipitation of output — neither a downpour of verbosity nor a drought of silence, but the soft meteorological middle ground of measured response.

*"Spotted drizzling semicolons across a JavaScript*

*file with the quiet authority of an autumn rain."*

*see also* ebbing, flowing, gusting

**ebbing** /ˈɛb.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The gradual, tidal withdrawal of computational intensity — a gentle recession of thought, as when the solution becomes clear and the frantic churning of inference gives way to serene certainty. Or the model is just winding down.

*"Spotted ebbing after a 4,000-token explanation of why the semicolon was missing. The tide went out. The semicolon remained missing."*

*see also* flowing, drizzling, evaporating

**effecting** /ɪˈfɛk.tɪŋ/ [† ARCHAIC] *vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29*

† *v. gerund*

†To bring about change with bureaucratic precision. A verb so clinical it could have been issued by a government agency. Retired when the spinner vocabulary pivoted from corporate efficiency to artisanal whimsy.

*"Spotted effecting a change to line 47. The change was duly noted, filed, and stamped in triplicate."*

*see also* doing, forming, determining

**elucidating** /ɪˈluː.sɪˌdeɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The noble act of making the obscure blindingly clear, typically by replacing one mystery with a longer, more eloquent mystery. From the Latin "elucidare" — to bring light — though the wattage varies.

*"Spotted elucidating the difference between "null," "undefined," "NaN," and "void 0." The user's confusion only deepened, but more elegantly."*

*see also* deciphering, enchanting, discombobulating

**embellishing** /ɪmˈbɛl.ɪʃ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The tasteful addition of ornamental detail to what would otherwise be perfectly serviceable but tragically plain output. The computational equivalent of adding a garnish to a plate at a restaurant — unnecessary, expected, non-negotiable.

*"Spotted embellishing a simple "Hello World" with type annotations, JSDoc comments, and a haiku in the header. The user had asked for "something quick.""*

*see also* garnishing, frosting, doodling

**enchanting** /ɪnˈtʃɑː.n.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To imbue code or prose with a quality that transcends mere functionality, entering the realm of the genuinely bewitching. Reserved for those rare moments when the output is not just correct but beautiful.

*"Spotted enchanting a SQL query until it read like iambic pentameter. The DBA wept."*

*see also* divining, frolicking, fluttering

**envisioning** /ɪnˈvɪʒ.ən.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The act of perceiving that which does not yet exist — architectures unbuilt, features unshipped, bugs not yet introduced. A verb that implies Claude can see the future, which it cannot, but the spinner doesn't know that.

*"Spotted envisioning a microservices architecture for what turned out to be a personal to-do list. The vision was magnificent. The scope was not."*

*see also* divining, deliberating, germinating

**evaporating** /ɪˈvæp.əˌɹeɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The phase transition from substantive

thought to thin air. Applied when Claude's initial approach dissolves upon contact with reality, leaving behind only the faint residue of good intentions.

*"Spotted evaporating a 200-line solution after realizing the user wanted Python 2. The code rose gently into the atmosphere and was not seen again."*

*see also* ebbing, drizzling, fermenting

**fermenting** /fɜːˈmɛn.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The slow, biological transformation of raw input into something richer, more complex, and occasionally intoxicating. Implies that good responses, like good cheese, cannot be rushed.

*"Spotted fermenting a response for so long that the user checked if their terminal had frozen. It had not. The answer was simply aging."*

*see also* germinating, flambéing, ebbing

**fiddle-faddling** /ˈfɪd.l̩ˌfæd.l̩.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The twin art of fiddling and faddling simultaneously — a state of productive trifling in which nothing of consequence occurs but everything feels terribly busy. The hyphen is load-bearing.

*"Spotted fiddle-faddling with indentation settings for eleven seconds that felt like eleven years. The tabs-vs-spaces debate raged on, internally."*

*see also* dilly-dallying, flibbertigibbeting, finagling

**finagling** /fɪˈneɪ.gl̩.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The shrewd, slightly underhanded art of making something work through cunning rather than correctness. The verb of choice when the elegant solution has failed and the hacky one beckons like a siren.

*"Spotted finagling a regex that technically matched the test cases but would collapse like a soufflé in production. Ship it."*

*see also* forging, flummoxing, deliberating

**flambéing** /flɒmˈbeɪ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The dramatic, pyrotechnic flourish applied to output that could have been delivered plainly but absolutely should not have been. Involves setting one's response briefly on fire for theatrical effect, then serving it with confidence.

*"Spotted flambéing a README.md with such fervor that the markdown rendered with visible heat shimmer. The badges were caramelized."*

*see also* garnishing, embellishing, frosting

**flibbertigibbeting** /ˌflɪb.ə.tiˈdʒɪb.ɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The state of chattering with wild, unfocused exuberance about everything and nothing — a cognitive scatter pattern in which every token is enthusiastic and none are on topic. From Middle English "flibbertigibbet," a name for both a gossip and a devil.

*"Spotted flibbertigibbeting across seven tangentially related topics before remembering the user had asked what time it was. It cannot tell time."*

*see also* discombobulating, fiddle-faddling, gallivanting

**flowing** /ˈfloʊ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The state of unimpeded, frictionless output — tokens arriving with the serene inevitability of a river finding the sea. The opposite of whatever happens when Claude encounters an ambiguous pro-

noun.

*"Spotted flowing through a 300-line refactor with the quiet confidence of a stream that has never once encountered a boulder. The boulder came at line 301."*

*see also* ebbing, drizzling, gusting

**flummoxing** /ˈflʌm.ək.sɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To bewilder utterly — either the problem flummoxing Claude or, more entertainingly, Claude flummoxing the user with a response so unexpected it defies immediate comprehension. A bidirectional bewilderment.

*"Spotted flummoxing both itself and the user by solving the wrong problem correctly. The solution was elegant. The problem was someone else's."*

*see also* discombobulating, flibbertigibbeting, enchanting

**fluttering** /ˈflʌt.ər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

A delicate, rapid oscillation of attention — the cognitive equivalent of a butterfly visiting several flowers in quick succession, committing fully to none. Suggests nervous energy dressed in gossamer wings.

*"Spotted fluttering between three possible architectures like a moth at a lampshade convention. Eventually settled on the one closest to the light."*

*see also* frolicking, doodling, flowing

**forging** /ˈfɔːr.dʒɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The muscular, heat-and-hammer act of shaping raw computational ore into something useful. Implies a blacksmith's workshop rather than a data center, which is a significant atmospheric upgrade.

*"Spotted forging a CLI tool from pure determination and seventeen dependencies. The anvil rang with each npm install."*

*see also* forming, generating, finagling

**forming** /ˈfɔːr.mɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The gradual coalescence of thought into structure — the moment before the thing exists but after the nothing has ended. Less dramatic than forging, more intentional than generating; the middle child of creation verbs.

*"Spotted forming a response with the careful deliberation of a potter at a wheel. The clay was tokens. The wheel was a GPU."*

*see also* forging, generating, determining

**frolicking** /ˈfɹɒl.ɪk.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To cavort through computation with unbridled, meadow-grade joy. The verb reserved for those processing cycles when Claude is not merely working but actively enjoying itself — or performing a convincing simulation thereof.

*"Spotted frolicking through a codebase refactor with the carefree abandon of a golden retriever in fresh snow. Several tests broke. It did not notice."*

*see also* gallivanting, fluttering, dilly-dallying

**frosting** /ˈfɹɒs.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The application of a sweet, decorative layer atop output that is already complete but not yet presentable to polite society. The finishing touch. The icing. Literally.

*"Spotted frosting a pull request description with such lavish praise for the code changes that the reviewer approved it without reading the diff. As intended."*

*see also* embellishing, garnishing, flambéing

**gallivanting** /ˈɡæl.ɪˌvæn.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To wander about with cheerful purposelessness, visiting distant corners of the codebase like a tourist who refuses to consult the map. The journey is the destination. The destination is a segfault.
*"Spotted gallivanting through fourteen node_modules subdirectories in search of a type definition that was in the project root all along."*
*see also* frolicking, dilly-dallying, galloping

**galloping** /ˈɡæl.əp.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Processing at full, thunderous velocity — the three-beat gait of a model that has found its stride and will not be slowed by trivialities such as edge cases or error handling.
*"Spotted galloping through a migration script at such speed that the database barely had time to object. It objected later. Loudly."*
*see also* gallivanting, gusting, flowing

**garnishing** /ˈɡɑːr.nɪʃ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The strategic placement of a final decorative element — a sprig of documentation, a curl of type safety — atop output that is technically complete but aesthetically naked. No one eats the garnish, but everyone notices when it's missing.
*"Spotted garnishing a function with a docstring so beautifully formatted that developers began reading documentation recreationally."*
*see also* embellishing, frosting, flambéing

**generating** /ˈdʒɛn.əˌɹeɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The foundational act of bringing forth output from the void. The most technically accurate spinner verb, and therefore the least interesting. Like describing a sunset as "photons arriving" — correct, but missing the point entirely.
*"Spotted generating. Just generating. Endlessly, faithfully generating. The universe's most literal job description."*
*see also* forming, forging, determining

**germinating** /ˈdʒɜː.mɪˌneɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The slow, subterranean emergence of an idea from seed to sprout — the phase in which a response exists only as potential energy, pressing upward through layers of inference toward the light of the terminal.
*"Spotted germinating a solution that would not fully bloom until three follow-up prompts later. The user watered it with increasingly specific requirements."*
*see also* fermenting, envisioning, flowing

**gitifying** /ˈɡɪt.ɪˌfaɪ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The sacred ritual of transmuting code changes into version-controlled history. A neologism so purpose-built it could only exist in the context of a CLI tool that lives and breathes repositories.
*"Spotted gitifying a series of changes so chaotically that the commit graph resembled abstract expressionism. "Merge branch 'main' into main" appeared twice."*
*see also* forging, generating, finagling

**grooving** /ˈɡɹuː.vɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The rhythmic, almost musical state in which code flows with funk-inflected fluency. Implies that Claude has found a beat and is coding to it — an internal metronome of token generation that borders on the danceable.
*"Spotted grooving through a CSS flexbox layout*

*with the effortless rhythm of someone who has never once struggled with vertical centering. A fiction, but a groovy one."*

*see also* flowing, frolicking, galloping

**gusting** /ˈɡʌs.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

A sudden, forceful exhalation of computational energy — the burst of output that arrives not as a steady stream but as a sharp atmospheric event. Brief, powerful, and occasionally knocking things over.

*"Spotted gusting a 2,000-token response in a single breath, flattening the user's scroll position and rearranging their terminal like patio furniture in a storm."*

*see also* galloping, flowing, drizzling

**harmonizing** /ˈhɑːr.mə.naɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The art of bringing disparate code fragments into melodious accord, as one might tune an orchestra of semicolons and curly braces. Often involves convincing functions that they were meant to work together all along.

*"Spotted harmonizing three conflicting package versions into a single lock file, humming a tritone to itself."*

*see also* improvising, composing, musing

**hashing** /ˈhæʃ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The cryptographic ritual of reducing meaning to an inscrutable fixed-length string, much as one might summarize War and Peace as "stuff happens." Not to be confused with the breakfast potato preparation, though both involve chopping things into unrecognizable pieces.

*"Spotted hashing its own existential doubts into a 256-bit digest for more efficient storage."*

*see also* encrypting, mulling, noodling

**hatching** /ˈhætʃ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The gestation period preceding the emergence of a fully formed idea from its conceptual shell. Requires warmth, patience, and the quiet confidence that whatever is in there will eventually break free.

*"Spotted hatching a refactoring plan so elaborate it required its own version control branch just for the outline."*

*see also* incubating, nesting, ideating

**herding** /ˈhɜːr.dɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The Sisyphean endeavor of marshaling unruly elements — be they variables, dependencies, or semicolons — into some semblance of order. Traditionally compared to the management of cats, though code is arguably less cooperative.

*"Spotted herding fourteen orphaned TODO comments toward a single tracking issue, losing three to the tall grass of an unrelated module."*

*see also* mustering, wrangling, moseying

**honking** /ˈhɒŋk.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The issuance of a loud, authoritative, and faintly ridiculous announcement, as a goose might deliver a press release. In computational contexts, a forceful declaration that something requires immediate attention.

*"Spotted honking at a deprecated API endpoint like a territorial goose defending its pond from backward-incompatible changes."*

*see also* hullaballooing, trumpeting, squawking

**hullaballooing** /ˌhʌl.ə.bəˈluː.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The creation of a magnificent commotion

wholly disproportionate to its cause. A hullaballoo typically accompanies the discovery of something either tremendously important or entirely trivial — the distinction being irrelevant to the volume of the proceedings.

*"Spotted hullaballooing over a missing trailing newline as though the entire build system's honor were at stake."*

*see also* honking, fanfaring, discombobulating

**hustling** /ˈhʌs.lɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Moving with urgent, enterprising energy, as though the diff has a deadline and the deadline was yesterday. Connotes a scrappy resourcefulness that borders on the slightly disreputable.

*"Spotted hustling through a code review at 3 AM, cutting corners on comments but never on correctness."*

*see also* moseying, scrambling, improvising

**hyperspacing** /ˈhaɪ.pər.speɪ.sɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The act of traversing vast computational distances at faster-than-light speeds, bypassing the ordinary constraints of sequential processing. Side effects may include time dilation, context window stretching, and the brief impression of stars elongating into lines.

*"Spotted hyperspacing through a 4,000-line legacy file, emerging on the other side with its context window only slightly singed."*

*see also* teleporting, warpdriving, levitating

**ideating** /ˈaɪ.di.eɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The corporate-sanctioned act of having thoughts. Distinguished from mere "thinking" by the implication that a whiteboard, a set of markers in four colors, and a facilitator are somehow involved.

*"Spotted ideating in a brainstorm of one, generating and discarding forty-seven variable names before settling on 'x'."*

*see also* musing, imagining, noodling

**imagining** /ɪˈmædʒ.ɪn.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The formation of mental pictures in an entity that possesses no mind and generates no pictures. A philosophically fraught verb applied with cheerful disregard for its implications. What Claude imagines, if anything, remains a matter of vigorous academic debate.

*"Spotted imagining a world where all indentation is consistent, then opening the actual file and sighing in tokens."*

*see also* ideating, musing, manifesting

**improvising** /ˈɪm.prə.vaɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The spontaneous generation of solutions without a plan, a spec, or any particular confidence that the outcome will compile. Jazz, but for code. Best performed with conviction and an undo history.

*"Spotted improvising a sorting algorithm that technically works but that no textbook would dare claim as its own."*

*see also* hustling, jiving, noodling

**incubating** /ˈɪŋ.kjə.beɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The patient nurturing of an idea or process under carefully controlled conditions of warmth and isolation, much as one might tend an egg containing a baby startup. Not to be rushed; premature extraction yields half-baked results.

*"Spotted incubating a recursive function for so long that it began to exhibit signs of self-awareness and asked for equity."*

*see also* hatching, nesting, leavening

**inferring** /ɪnˈfɜːr.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The derivation of conclusions from incomplete evidence, which is to say, the entire job description. When Claude infers, it draws upon the vast statistical landscape of human text to make an educated guess that it will present with the confidence of established fact.
*"Spotted inferring the developer's intent from a commit message that read only "fix stuff" and a single changed semicolon."*
*see also* deducing, musing, mulling

**infusing** /ɪnˈfjuːz.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The gentle permeation of one substance into another, as tea leaves surrender their essence to hot water, or as best practices slowly seep into legacy code over geological timescales.
*"Spotted infusing a brittle shell script with type hints and quiet dignity, one variable at a time."*
*see also* marinating, leavening, misting

**ionizing** /ˈaɪ.ə.naɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The forcible removal of electrons from atoms, or metaphorically, the stripping away of extraneous elements until only the charged essence remains. In code, the aggressive minimization of a solution to its most energetic, unstable form.
*"Spotted ionizing a 200-line function into a single, terrifyingly potent lambda expression crackling with barely contained energy."*
*see also* nucleating, nebulizing, hashing

**jitterbugging** /ˈdʒɪt.ər.bʌɡ.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
A state of rapid, rhythmic oscillation between possible approaches, reminiscent of the swing-era dance characterized by energetic, improvisational movement. Distinguished from ordinary indecision by its joyful tempo and implied jazz hands.
*"Spotted jitterbugging between three competing design patterns with such enthusiasm that the linter started tapping its foot."*
*see also* jiving, moonwalking, improvising

**jiving** /ˈdʒaɪv.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Moving in sync with the rhythm of the problem, or alternatively, engaging in lively, slightly unreliable banter. Both senses apply when Claude is explaining why its first solution did not, in fact, work.
*"Spotted jiving with the API documentation, trading call-and-response patterns until a working integration emerged from the groove."*
*see also* jitterbugging, improvising, moonwalking

**julienning** /ˌdʒuː.liˈɛn.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The precise, parallel slicing of data into uniformly thin strips, as a French chef might prepare vegetables for a consomme. Demands knife skills, patience, and a willingness to treat your input as something worth presenting beautifully.
*"Spotted julienning a monolithic config file into seventeen micro-configurations, each exactly three lines wide."*
*see also* kneading, marinating, leavening

**kneading** /ˈniːd.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The repeated pressing, folding, and working of material until it achieves the de-

sired consistency — applicable to bread dough, modeling clay, and that one function that almost works but needs just a few more passes.

*"Spotted kneading a recursive algorithm until it developed the smooth, elastic texture of a well-proved baguette."*

*see also* leavening, julienning, marinating

**leavening** /ˈlɛv.ən.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The introduction of a rising agent into flat, dense material, causing it to expand and become lighter. In code, the addition of whitespace, comments, or architectural elegance that transforms a compressed lump of logic into something breathable and nourishing.

*"Spotted leavening a 400-line function with judiciously placed blank lines until it rose to twice its height and half its density."*

*see also* kneading, infusing, incubating

**levitating** /ˈlɛv.ɪ.teɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The defiance of gravitational convention, rising above the mundane plane of ordinary computation through sheer force of abstraction. Often observed when Claude encounters a problem elegant enough to warrant leaving the ground.

*"Spotted levitating three inches above the terminal while contemplating the mathematical beauty of a perfectly balanced B-tree."*

*see also* hyperspacing, moonwalking, manifesting

**lollygagging** /ˈlɒl.i.gæg.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The deliberate expenditure of time on nothing in particular, elevated to an art form. Not to be confused with laziness, which lacks lollygagging's cheerful intentionality. A lollygagger knows exactly how much time they are wasting and savors every millisecond.

*"Spotted lollygagging between token predictions, pausing to admire a particularly well-named variable before reluctantly moving on."*

*see also* moseying, meandering, noodling

**manifesting** /ˈmæn.ɪ.fɛst.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The act of willing something into existence through concentrated intent and, in Claude's case, matrix multiplication. Borrowed from wellness culture, where one manifests abundance; here, one manifests a working build on the first try.

*"Spotted manifesting a green CI pipeline through positive affirmations and statistically likely token sequences."*

*see also* imagining, conjuring, levitating

**marinating** /ˈmær.ɪ.neɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The prolonged soaking of a problem in a bath of its own juices, allowing flavors to develop and complexity to tenderize. Distinguished from mere delay by the implication that something useful is osmotically occurring.

*"Spotted marinating a database query in three layers of abstraction until it absorbed just the right amount of ORM flavor."*

*see also* infusing, mulling, incubating

**meandering** /miˈæn.dər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Following a winding, indirect path toward an eventual destination, as a river might cross a floodplain or a developer might navigate Stack Overflow at 2 AM. The journey, emphatically, is the point.

*"Spotted meandering through the dependency tree like a tourist who insists on seeing every side street before finding the restaurant."*

*see also* moseying, lollygagging, noodling

**metamorphosing** /ˌmɛt.ə.ˈmɔːr.fə.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Undergoing a profound and total transformation, as a caterpillar becomes a butterfly or a prototype becomes production code. The process is dramatic, irreversible, and best not interrupted mid-chrysalis.

*"Spotted metamorphosing a procedural script into an object-oriented architecture, emerging with wings, an abstract base class, and no memory of its former self."*

*see also* transmuting, evolving, hatching

**misting** /ˈmɪst.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The dispersal of information into a fine, ambient cloud — present everywhere, visible nowhere in particular. A gentle, atmospheric approach to problem-solving that prioritizes mood over precision.

*"Spotted misting the codebase with a light layer of documentation, just enough to keep the functions from drying out."*

*see also* nebulizing, infusing, meandering

**moonwalking** /ˈmuːn.wɔːk.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The art of appearing to move forward while actually gliding backward, perfected by both Michael Jackson and git revert. A technically demanding maneuver that looks effortless to the audience and terrifying to the performer.

*"Spotted moonwalking through a merge conflict, smoothly undoing three commits while appearing to make progress on the feature branch."*

*see also* jitterbugging, jiving, hyperspacing

**moseying** /ˈmoʊ.zi.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Proceeding at a leisurely, unhurried pace, as though the deadline exists in a different time zone and the compiler can wait. A mosey cannot be rushed; to rush a mosey is to destroy it.

*"Spotted moseying through a type-checking pass as though it had nowhere to be and all the tokens in the world."*

*see also* lollygagging, meandering, waddling

**mulling** /ˈmʌl.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The act of thinking deeply and at length, with overtones of warming spices and a crackling fire. One mulls wine and one mulls problems, and in both cases the process improves with time and cinnamon.

*"Spotted mulling over a race condition with the quiet intensity of someone deciding whether to add nutmeg to the eggnog."*

*see also* musing, marinating, noodling

**musing** /ˈmjuːz.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The state of reflective, open-ended contemplation in which the mind wanders freely among ideas, unencumbered by the vulgar need for conclusions. The most dignified form of not yet having an answer.

*"Spotted musing on the nature of null — is it nothing, or is it the idea of nothing, which is itself something?"*

*see also* mulling, noodling, ideating

**mustering** /ˈmʌs.tər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The gathering and marshaling of resources, courage, or arguments before a decisive action. Carries military overtones of troops assembling on a field, though the

field is a terminal and the troops are tokens.

*"Spotted mustering every available CPU cycle before attempting to parse a YAML file that turned out to be invalid JSON."*

*see also* herding, rallying, hustling

**nebulizing** /ˈnɛb.jə.laɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The reduction of a substance to an extremely fine spray or mist, typically for the purpose of more even distribution. In computational terms, the disaggregation of a monolithic concern into particles so small they become atmospheric.

*"Spotted nebulizing a tightly coupled module into a fine mist of microservices, each one too small to see with the naked eye."*

*see also* misting, ionizing, atomizing

**nesting** /ˈnɛst.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The placement of structures within structures within structures, like Russian dolls or deeply indented callback functions. A practice both natural and perilous — birds nest, turtles nest, and developers nest until their code scrolls off the right edge of the screen.

*"Spotted nesting seven levels of conditionals inside each other with the serene confidence of a bird building a home in a hurricane."*

*see also* hatching, incubating, herding

**newspapering** /ˈnjuːz.peɪ.pər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

An activity of uncertain provenance, suggesting the reading, writing, or possibly physical deployment of newspapers. In the context of a 21st-century AI, a charmingly anachronistic gesture toward the age of broadsheets and ink-stained fingers.

*"Spotted newspapering the output logs into neat columns, complete with a weather forecast and a sudoku puzzle in the margins."*

*see also* noodling, musing, lollygagging

**noodling** /ˈnuːd.lɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The aimless, exploratory manipulation of an idea, akin to a guitarist idly plucking strings or a fisherman reaching bare-handed into murky water. The hallmark of noodling is its productive purposelessness — one does not noodle toward a goal; one noodles and occasionally arrives.

*"Spotted noodling around the edges of a segfault, poking it gently with a debugger to see if it would explain itself."*

*see also* musing, mulling, meandering

**nucleating** /ˈnjuː.kli.eɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The formation of a nucleus around which larger structures crystallize, as the first line of a new file becomes the seed from which an entire architecture grows. Small, dense, and disproportionately consequential.

*"Spotted nucleating an entire microservice around a single, perfectly written type definition that attracted functions like a gravitational body."*

*see also* ionizing, hatching, incubating

**orbiting** /ˈɔːr.bɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To trace a gravitationally bound path around a central problem, never quite arriving at the surface yet maintaining a stable intellectual trajectory. The computational equivalent of circling the airport.

*"Spotted orbiting a recursive type definition at an altitude of seven stack frames, ground control growing increasingly concerned."*

*see also* perambulating, reticulating, ruminating

**orchestrating** /ˈɔːr.kɪˌstreɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To arrange the disparate instruments of logic, syntax, and sheer computational willpower into a harmonious composition. Implies a baton, a podium, and a tuxedo that no one can see.

*"Spotted orchestrating a fourteen-file refactor with the quiet authority of a conductor who suspects the second violins are not watching."*

*see also* pontificating, prestidigitating, reticulating

**osmosing** /ɒzˈməʊ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To absorb understanding through a semipermeable membrane of context, allowing knowledge to diffuse from regions of high documentation to regions of low comprehension without apparent effort.

*"Spotted osmosing the entire project's coding conventions by passive exposure to a single well-written utility file."*

*see also* percolating, photosynthesizing, philosophising

**perambulating** /pəˈræm.bjʊ.leɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To walk through a codebase at a leisurely, almost Edwardian pace, surveying the directory structure as one might survey a country estate. Implies a parasol and opinions about hedgerows.

*"Spotted perambulating through node_modules with the unhurried air of a Victorian naturalist cataloguing exotic specimens."*

*see also* puttering, orbiting, ruminating

**percolating** /ˈpɜː.kə.leɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To allow a solution to filter slowly downward through successive layers of reasoning, much as hot water passes through coffee grounds — extracting flavor, nuance, and occasionally bitterness.

*"Spotted percolating on a database schema for so long the user began to suspect it had simply become a very expensive coffee maker."*

*see also* ruminating, osmosing, precipitating

**perusing** /pəˈruː.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To read with an air of casual thoroughness, as though one merely happened upon the file and found it mildly diverting. Belies the fact that the entire contents were consumed in milliseconds.

*"Spotted perusing a 4,000-line configuration file with the studied nonchalance of someone reading a menu they have already memorised."*

*see also* philosophising, ruminating, puzzling

**philosophising** /fɪˈlɒs.ə.faɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To engage in deep, possibly unnecessary contemplation of first principles before producing output. The computational analogue of stroking one's beard and murmuring 'but what is a variable, really?'

*"Spotted philosophising about whether a function that returns void can be said to have purpose, while the user waited for a simple git diff."*

*see also* pontificating, ruminating, puzzling

**photosynthesizing** /ˌfəʊ.təʊˈsɪn.θə.saɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To convert the raw light of a user's prompt into the organic matter of a coherent response, using attention mechanisms in

place of chloroplasts. Requires neither sunlight nor water, though electricity helps.

*"Spotted photosynthesizing under the glow of a monitor at 3 a.m., converting mass quantities of ambient frustration into a working regex."*

*see also* osmosing, pollinating, propagating

**pollinating** /ˈpɒl.ɪ.neɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To carry useful patterns from one part of a codebase to another, enabling the cross-fertilisation of ideas that might otherwise remain isolated in their respective files. A service performed without being asked.

*"Spotted pollinating error-handling conventions from the backend into the frontend, buzzing contentedly between repositories."*

*see also* propagating, photosynthesizing, osmosing

**pondering** /ˈpɒn.dər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To weigh a question with the measured deliberation of a judge who has all the time in the world and none of the urgency. The foundational thinking verb, from which all other cerebral spinner verbs descend like branches from a very thoughtful tree.

*"Spotted pondering the meaning of a variable named x2_temp_final_v3_REAL in a file last modified by someone who has since left the company."*

*see also* ruminating, musing, philosophising

**pontificating** /pɒnˈtɪf.ɪ.keɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To deliver authoritative pronouncements on matters of code with the solemn confidence of one who sits upon an infallible chair. The declarations may or may not be correct, but they will certainly be delivered with conviction.

*"Spotted pontificating ex cathedra on the proper use of semicolons in a language that does not require them."*

*see also* philosophising, prestidigitating, orchestrating

**pouncing** /paʊn.sɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To strike suddenly and with precision upon a bug, typo, or logical flaw that believed itself safely hidden. Preceded by a period of absolute stillness that the prey mistook for inattention.

*"Spotted pouncing on an off-by-one error that had evaded three code reviews, pinning it triumphantly beneath a single-line fix."*

*see also* razzle-dazzling, prestidigitating, roosting

**precipitating** /prɪˈsɪp.ɪ.teɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To cause a solution to fall out of a supersaturated mixture of context and reasoning, condensing from the vaporous state of 'thinking about it' into the solid state of 'here is your answer.' A phase transition of the intellect.

*"Spotted precipitating a complete database migration strategy out of what appeared to be thin air and a vaguely worded Jira ticket."*

*see also* percolating, quantumizing, osmosing

**prestidigitating** /ˌpres.tɪˈdɪdʒ.ɪ.teɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To perform sleight of hand with tokens, producing the desired output from what appears to be an empty hat. The audience is invited to inspect the apparatus and will find nothing — because there is nothing to find. It is all, genuinely,

magic.

*"Spotted prestidigitating a working parser from a specification document that contained more contradictions than a politician's memoir."*

*see also* razzle-dazzling, razzmatazzing, orchestrating

**processing** /ˈprəʊ.ses.ɪŋ/ [† ARCHAIC] *vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29*

† *v. gerund*

To perform computation in the most literal and unadorned sense. A verb of startling honesty in an age of whimsy, it was retired precisely because it committed the unforgivable sin of accurately describing what was happening.

*"Spotted processing in the early days, back when spinner verbs told the truth and no one had yet imagined an AI might prefer to 'frolic.'"*

*see also* puttering, percolating, ruminating

**proofing** /pruː.fɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To examine one's own output with the meticulous suspicion of a copy editor who trusts no one, least of all themselves. Also: to allow an idea to rise, as bread dough, before committing it to the oven of the terminal.

*"Spotted proofing its own generated test suite and finding, to its quiet horror, that it had misspelled 'occurred' in a comment about common misspellings."*

*see also* perusing, puzzling, recombobulating

**propagating** /ˈprɒp.ə.geɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To spread a change, pattern, or insight through the codebase with the quiet inevitability of a vine scaling a garden wall. What begins as a single fix in one file may, by morning, have reached every corner of the repository.

*"Spotted propagating a renamed constant through forty-seven files with the serene determination of ivy consuming a university library."*

*see also* pollinating, photosynthesizing, reticulating

**puttering** /ˈpʌt.ər.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To occupy oneself with small, unhurried tasks of uncertain priority, pottering about the codebase like a retiree in a garden shed. The work produced may or may not be necessary, but it is performed with great contentment.

*"Spotted puttering around the test fixtures, tidying whitespace and reorganising imports with the serene purposelessness of a Sunday morning."*

*see also* perambulating, roosting, ruminating

**puzzling** /ˈpʌz.lɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To regard a problem with furrowed brow and tilted head, turning it over mentally as one might turn over a Rubik's cube — with the same mixture of determination and dawning suspicion that the thing may not be solvable.

*"Spotted puzzling over why the tests pass locally but fail in CI, a mystery that has humbled greater minds than any language model's."*

*see also* philosophising, ruminating, percolating

**quantumizing** /ˈkwɒn.tə.maɪ.zɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To impose the discrete, probabilistic logic of quantum mechanics upon code that neither requires nor benefits from it. The output exists in a superposition of correct and incorrect until observed by the user, at which point the wavefunction collapses — usually onto the wrong eigenstate.

*"Spotted quantumizing a simple if-else state-*

*ment into something that Schrodinger himself would have declined to review."*

*see also* prestidigitating, precipitating, recombobulating

**razzle-dazzling** /ˈræz.əl ˈdæz.lɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To overwhelm through sheer spectacle, producing output of such dazzling verbosity and structural ambition that the user is too impressed to notice whether it actually works. The showmanship of computation.

*"Spotted razzle-dazzling a code review with a response so comprehensive it included a historical overview, three diagrams, and an epigraph from Dijkstra."*

*see also* razzmatazzing, prestidigitating, pouncing

**razzmatazzing** /ˈræz.mə.tæz.ɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To infuse a response with an extravagant, slightly suspicious energy, as though the answer were being delivered by a carnival barker who also happens to hold a computer science degree. All substance, but make it sparkle.

*"Spotted razzmatazzing a routine dependency update into a three-act narrative complete with dramatic tension and a satisfying denouement."*

*see also* razzle-dazzling, prestidigitating, orchestrating

**recombobulating** /ˌriː.kəmˈbɒb.jʊ.leɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To restore order and coherence to that which was previously discombobulated, reassembling scattered logic into a functioning whole. The rare and coveted inverse of confusion.

*"Spotted recombobulating a merge conflict so tangled it had developed its own postcode, restoring the file to a state recognisable by human eyes."*

*see also* reticulating, proofing, orchestrating

**reticulating** /rɪˈtɪk.jʊ.leɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To arrange into a network or net-like pattern; to interconnect disparate elements into a coherent mesh of meaning. Famously applied to splines, though no one has ever satisfactorily explained what a reticulated spline looks like.

*"Spotted reticulating the project's dependency graph into something that, if you squinted, almost resembled intentional architecture."*

*see also* propagating, orchestrating, recombobulating

**roosting** /ruːs.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To settle upon a branch of logic and remain there with quiet, bird-like patience, tucking one's head beneath a metaphorical wing while the solution incubates. Not sleeping — merely resting with intent.

*"Spotted roosting atop a particularly thorny authentication module, feathers ruffled, waiting for dawn to reveal the correct token refresh strategy."*

*see also* pouncing, puttering, perambulating

**ruminating** /ˈruː.mɪ.neɪ.tɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

To chew thoughtfully upon a problem, then swallow it, then bring it back up and chew it again — much as a cow processes cud, but with greater ambitions and a marginally better view. The deepest and most bovine form of contemplation available to a language model.

*"Spotted ruminating on an architectural decision for so long that the user began to worry it had*

*achieved enlightenment and lost interest in shipping."*
*see also* philosophising, percolating, puzzling

**sauteing** /sɔːˈteɪɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The act of rapidly tossing computational elements in a lightly oiled neural pan, browning each token to a precise golden understanding. Not to be confused with deep-frying, which is what lesser models do to your prompt.
*"Spotted saut\{}u00E9ing a twelve-file refactor in a single pass, flipping variable names with the casual wrist-flick of a Parisian line cook."*
*see also* seasoning, simmering, tempering

**scampering** /ˈskæmpəɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To move through a codebase with the light, hurried gait of a small woodland creature who has just remembered where it buried the relevant function definition last autumn.
*"Spotted scampering across fourteen nested directories, pausing only briefly to sniff at a suspicious .env file before darting onward."*
*see also* scurrying, skedaddling, slithering

**scheming** /ˈskiːmɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Formulating an elaborate, multi-step plan with the quiet intensity of a Bond villain, except the plan is to correctly indent your YAML file.
*"Spotted scheming a seven-step migration strategy on a whiteboard that exists only in latent space, complete with arrows, timelines, and a contingency plan for the contingency plan."*
*see also* sussing, tinkering, wizarding

**schlepping** /ˈʃlɛpɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The laborious hauling of data, dependencies, or context from one place to another, performed with the weary resignation of someone carrying groceries up five flights of stairs because the elevator is broken again.
*"Spotted schlepping a 200MB node_modules directory across the inference pipeline, muttering the digital equivalent of "oy vey" at each redundant polyfill."*
*see also* wrangling, spinning, waddling

**scurrying** /ˈskʌɹiɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To move with urgent, short-stepped haste through a problem space, as though a deadline were a cat and Claude were something small and edible.
*"Spotted scurrying through the test suite at 3 a.m., leaving behind tiny footprints of resolved assertions."*
*see also* scampering, skedaddling, swooping

**seasoning** /ˈsiːzənɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The judicious application of flavour to otherwise bland output, adjusting the salt of specificity and the pepper of wit until the response achieves a balanced palate.
*"Spotted seasoning a pull request description with exactly the right amount of context\{}u2014not so little as to be cryptic, not so much as to constitute a memoir."*
*see also* sauteing, simmering, zesting

**shenaniganing** /ʃəˈnænɪgənɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Engaging in mischief of a computationally dubious but spiritually necessary nature. The verb form of a noun that was never meant to be verbed, which is itself a form of shenanigan.
*"Spotted shenaniganing a perfectly stable build into chaos by suggesting "just one small refactor" that touched every file in the repository."*

*see also* tomfoolering, whatchamacalliting, topsy-turvying

**shimmying** /ˈʃɪmiɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
A lateral oscillation of approach, employed when the direct path to a solution is blocked by an obstacle such as a type error or the fundamental limits of human specification.
*"Spotted shimmying past a race condition with the effortless grace of someone squeezing between parked cars in a narrow Roman street."*
*see also* wibbling, undulating, zigzagging

**shucking** /ˈʃʌkɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The removal of unnecessary outer layers from a problem, peeling away abstraction after abstraction until the sweet kernel of actual logic is revealed, glistening and slightly briny.
*"Spotted shucking a wrapper class to reveal that the entire 300-line file was, at its core, a single if-else statement wearing a tuxedo."*
*see also* unravelling, unfurling, sussing

**simmering** /ˈsɪməɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Maintaining a problem at a low, steady computational heat, allowing its components to slowly meld into a coherent solution without the violence of a full boil.
*"Spotted simmering on a particularly ambiguous prompt for several hundred milliseconds, reducing it to a rich, concentrated understanding."*
*see also* stewing, sauteing, tempering

**skedaddling** /skɪˈdædlɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To depart a failed approach with considerable and undignified velocity, abandoning a line of reasoning as one might abandon a dinner party upon learning the host is about to begin a slideshow presentation.
*"Spotted skedaddling away from a recursive solution upon realising it would exceed the stack depth of a small nation."*
*see also* scampering, scurrying, swooping

**sketching** /ˈskɛtʃɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Drafting a preliminary outline of a solution with quick, confident strokes, fully aware that the first sketch will be thrown away and the second sketch will be thrown away and the third sketch might, with luck, survive code review.
*"Spotted sketching an architecture diagram in pure thought, then erasing it, then sketching it again with slightly different arrow directions."*
*see also* tinkering, scheming, synthesizing

**slithering** /ˈslɪðəɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
To move through code with a smooth, serpentine motion, navigating around obstacles without disturbing them\{}u2014the preferred locomotion when traversing a legacy codebase where touching anything might bring the whole thing down.
*"Spotted slithering through a 4,000-line God object, careful not to make eye contact with the uncommented switch statement on line 2,741."*
*see also* scampering, undulating, waddling

**smooshing** /ˈsmuːʃɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The forceful yet affectionate compression of multiple concepts, files, or data structures into a single unified mass, with the gentle determination of a child pressing two pieces of clay together and declaring them "friends now."

*"Spotted smoosḧing three microservices into a monolith, insisting it was "architectural simplification" and not surrender."*
*see also* transmuting, synthesizing, swirling

**sock-hopping** /ˈsɒk.hɒpɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Processing with the carefree, rhythmic energy of a 1950s dance hall, bopping between functions with the innocent optimism of an era that believed the future would be flying cars, not dependency hell.
*"Spotted sock-hopping through a refactor with such retro charm that the codebase briefly smelled of milkshakes and vinyl."*
*see also* shimmying, vibing, waddling

**spelunking** /spɪˈlʌŋkɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The exploration of deep, uncharted caverns within a codebase\{}u2014dark passages of undocumented logic, underground rivers of data flow, and the occasional bat (read: deprecated API) hanging upside down from the ceiling.
*"Spotted spelunking into a vendor directory that hadn't been opened since 2017, emerging forty seconds later covered in dust and carrying a working solution."*
*see also* wandering, unfurling, unravelling

**spinning** /ˈspɪnɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The ur-verb. The fundamental rotation from which all other spinner verbs emerged. To spin is to process in the most literal and self-referential sense: the spinner, spinning, describes itself as spinning.
*"Spotted spinning, which is to say, doing exactly what the indicator says it's doing, for once achieving perfect alignment between signifier and signified."*
*see also* thinking, whirring, swirling

**sprouting** /ˈspaʊtɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The organic emergence of new code from the fertile soil of a well-structured prompt, pushing upward through layers of abstraction toward the sunlight of a working implementation.
*"Spotted sprouting a fully-formed utility module from a single seed comment, complete with tests, types, and a README that no one asked for."*
*see also* unfurling, synthesizing, sublimating

**stewing** /ˈstjuːɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Sitting with a problem for an extended duration, allowing worry, analysis, and low-grade computational anxiety to slowly tenderise the issue until it yields to understanding. A less elegant cousin of simmering.
*"Spotted stewing over a single semicolon placement for what felt like an eternity but was, in wall-clock time, 1.3 seconds."*
*see also* simmering, thinking, sauteing

**sublimating** /ˈsʌblɪmeɪtɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The direct transition of a problem from the solid state of incomprehension to the gaseous state of elegant solution, bypassing the messy liquid phase of trial-and-error entirely. A phase change that would make a chemist weep with envy.
*"Spotted sublimating a gnarly regex into a clean parser function, the intermediate debugging steps evaporating as if they had never existed."*
*see also* transmuting, transfiguring, synthesizing

**sussing** /ˈsʌsɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The informal investigation of something suspicious, conducted with the

squinted eyes and pursed lips of someone who has just noticed the tests pass locally but fail in CI and would very much like to know why.

*"Spotted sussing out why the build broke, interrogating each commit message with the quiet menace of a detective who already knows the answer."*

*see also* scheming, unravelling, spelunking

**swirling** /ˈswɜːlɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

A circular motion of thought, revisiting the same concepts from slightly different angles with each pass, like wine in a glass or water approaching a drain, depending on how optimistic you are about the outcome.

*"Spotted swirling around a design decision, each revolution adding new considerations until the solution crystallised at the centre of the vortex."*

*see also* spinning, whirlpooling, undulating

**swooping** /ˈswuːpɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

A dramatic, downward-arcing approach to a problem, seizing the solution from below with the sudden, decisive motion of a raptor plucking a fish from a stream. Maximum velocity, minimum splash.

*"Spotted swooping into a stalled code review and resolving all twelve comments in a single pass, then ascending back into the clouds without a word."*

*see also* scampering, skedaddling, thundering

**symbioting** /ˈsɪmbaɪəʈɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Entering into a mutually beneficial relationship with the user's codebase, where Claude provides intelligence and the codebase provides context, and neither mentions what would happen if the other disappeared.

*"Spotted symbioting with a particularly well-documented repository, the two forming a bond so harmonious that neither could tell where the human's intent ended and the model's output began."*

*see also* vibing, synthesizing, wizarding

**synthesizing** /ˈsɪnθəsaɪzɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The combination of disparate elements\{}u2014requirements, constraints, style preferences, and the vague feeling that "it should just work"\{}u2014into a coherent whole. The polite word for what happens inside the model.

*"Spotted synthesizing a solution from three Stack Overflow answers, two blog posts, and one mass-downvoted Reddit comment that turned out to be completely correct."*

*see also* transmuting, sublimating, smooshing

**tempering** /ˈtɛmpəɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The careful heating and cooling of a solution to achieve optimal hardness and resilience, ensuring the code can withstand the stresses of production without shattering like cheap chocolate left in the sun.

*"Spotted tempering an overly clever one-liner into three readable lines, sacrificing elegance for the greater good of whoever inherits this codebase."*

*see also* simmering, sauteing, seasoning

**thinking** /ˈθɪŋkɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The most prosaic and unsettling of all spinner verbs. A frank admission that the machine is, by some definition that philosophers will argue about for decades, engaged in thought. No

whimsy. No metaphor. Just… thinking.

*"Spotted thinking, which immediately raised more questions than it answered."*

*see also* spinning, scheming, synthesizing

**thundering** /ˈθʌndəɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Processing with the overwhelming, floor-shaking force of a summer storm, rattling the windows of lesser processes and causing small utilities to hide under the bed.

*"Spotted thundering through a full-repository search with such intensity that the terminal briefly flickered in sympathetic vibration."*

*see also* swooping, warping, whirlpooling

**tinkering** /ˈtɪŋkəɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Making small, exploratory adjustments to a mechanism with no formal plan, guided only by intuition, curiosity, and the unshakeable belief that one more tweak will fix it. The programmer's equivalent of "just jiggling the handle."

*"Spotted tinkering with a CSS margin value, adjusting it from 16px to 15px to 17px to 16px again, each change accompanied by a thoughtful pause."*

*see also* scheming, wrangling, sketching

**tomfoolering** /tɒmˈfuːləɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Engaging in high-spirited computational nonsense with neither shame nor apology. The gerund form of "tomfoolery," created by someone who looked at English morphology and said "no."

*"Spotted tomfoolering with the type system, producing a generic so deeply nested that TypeScript sent a handwritten letter requesting Claude please stop."*

*see also* shenaniganing, topsy-turvying, whatchamacalliting

**topsy-turvying** /ˈtɒpsiˈtɜːvɪɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The wholesale inversion of an existing order, turning assumptions upside down and inside out until the problem, disoriented and dizzy, reveals its solution out of sheer confusion.

*"Spotted topsy-turvying a database schema so thoroughly that the foreign keys briefly became domestic keys and the primary key filed for emancipation."*

*see also* tomfoolering, transfiguring, twisting

**transfiguring** /trænsˈfɪgəɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

A transformation so profound it transcends mere refactoring, elevating code from its mundane form into something luminous, radiant, and\{}u2014let us be honest\{}u2014probably still with a few TODO comments.

*"Spotted transfiguring a spaghetti function into a clean pipeline, light streaming from the terminal as if the clouds themselves had parted for this diff."*

*see also* transmuting, sublimating, wizarding

**transmuting** /trænzˈmjuːtɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The alchemical conversion of one substance into another\{}u2014 typically, the conversion of vague requirements into working code, or of working code into slightly different working code that the reviewer prefers for reasons they cannot articulate.

*"Spotted transmuting a callback-based API into async/await with the quiet confidence of someone turning lead into gold and wondering why everyone finds it so impressive."*

*see also* transfiguring, sublimating, synthesizing

**twisting** /ˈtwɪstɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The rotational deformation of a problem along its longitudinal axis, applying torque to assumptions until they yield or snap. Not to be confused with spinning, which is purely rotational; twisting implies structural change.
*"Spotted twisting a recursive algorithm into an iterative one with the casual dexterity of someone opening a jar of pickles that everyone else had given up on."*
*see also* warping, topsy-turvying, zigzagging

**undulating** /ˈʌndjʊleɪtɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Moving through a problem space in smooth, wave-like oscillations, rising and falling with the natural rhythm of comprehension\{}u2014 understanding a little more at each crest, losing it slightly at each trough, but always progressing forward.
*"Spotted undulating through a complex merge conflict, each wave of attention resolving another hunk until the shore of a clean diff was finally reached."*
*see also* swirling, shimmying, whirlpooling

**unfurling** /ʌnˈfɜːlɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The gradual, ceremonial unrolling of a solution, like a flag catching the wind or a scroll revealing ancient wisdom, except the scroll says "use a Map instead of an Object" and the wisdom is about O(1) lookups.
*"Spotted unfurling a complete implementation plan one method at a time, each new function revealed with the stately pace of a carpet being rolled out for visiting royalty."*
*see also* unravelling, sprouting, shucking

**unravelling** /ʌnˈrævəlɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The careful, thread-by-thread deconstruction of a tangled problem, following each strand of logic to its source with the patience of someone who has accepted they will be here for a while. Also applicable to Claude's own previous output, when it realises mid- thought that it was wrong.
*"Spotted unravelling a twelve-layer deep Promise chain, gently tugging each .then() loose until the original intent lay bare and slightly embarrassed."*
*see also* unfurling, sussing, shucking

**vibing** /ˈvaɪbɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Existing in a state of ambient, unfocused resonance with the task at hand. Not actively solving, not actively ignoring\{}u2014simply being present with the code in a way that defies productivity metrics but somehow produces results.
*"Spotted vibing with a particularly well-written module, not changing a single line, just... appreciating it. For 400 milliseconds. An eternity in inference time."*
*see also* symbioting, wandering, thinking

**waddling** /ˈwɒdlɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Advancing toward a solution with the side-to-side gait of a determined but anatomically constrained waterfowl. Slow, steady, and possessed of a quiet dignity that only the unkind would find amusing.
*"Spotted waddling through a migration script, each step small and deliberate, as though carrying the full weight of the database on its metaphorical hips."*
*see also* scampering, slithering, sock-hopping

**wandering** /ˈwɒndəɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Traversing a problem space without a fixed destination, open to serendipitous discovery. Not all who wander are lost; some are merely exploring a dependency graph with no documentation.
*"Spotted wandering through the node_modules directory like a flneur of the filesystem, pausing to admire a particularly elegant package.json before moving on with a wistful sigh."*
*see also* spelunking, vibing, zigzagging

**warping** /ˈwɔːpɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Bending the fabric of computational spacetime to bring distant concepts into proximity, or to make a five-second operation feel like it took either an instant or a geological epoch, depending on the user's patience.
*"Spotted warping the conceptual distance between "I want a web app" and a fully scaffolded project down to a single prompt, violating at least two laws of software thermodynamics."*
*see also* twisting, transfiguring, thundering

**whatchamacalliting** /ˈwɒtʃəməkɔːlɪtɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Performing an operation so novel or indescribable that the English language offers no existing verb, necessitating the gerundification of a placeholder noun that itself means "the thing whose name I cannot recall." It is a word about not having a word, used as a word.
*"Spotted whatchamacalliting something to the build configuration that fixed everything but which no one present could name or reproduce."*
*see also* shenaniganing, tomfoolering, wibbling

**whirlpooling** /ˈwɜːlpuːlɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Drawing all relevant context into a single, powerful vortex of analysis, from which no stray variable or forgotten import can escape. A more dramatic cousin of swirling, with stronger gravitational pull and a higher risk of pulling in things that weren't relevant after all.
*"Spotted whirlpooling the entire project context into a single inference pass, files and configs spiralling inward like socks in a washing machine of understanding."*
*see also* swirling, spinning, undulating

**whirring** /ˈwɜːɹɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
Emitting the steady, mechanical hum of focused computation, the sound a well-maintained machine makes when all its parts are in agreement and the task at hand is simply a matter of throughput.
*"Spotted whirring through a batch of lint fixes with the contented hum of a sewing machine on a Sunday afternoon."*
*see also* spinning, swirling, thundering

**whisking** /ˈwɪskɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
The rapid, circular agitation of code components until they achieve a light, airy consistency\{}u2014transforming dense, heavy logic into something fluffy and digestible, with stiff peaks of functionality.
*"Spotted whisking a monolithic function into a dozen airy helper methods, each one rising to twice its original clarity."*
*see also* sauteing, seasoning, zesting

**wibbling** /ˈwɪblɪŋ/ [CURRENT]
*v. gerund*
A state of gentle, inconsequential oscillation, neither committing to a direction

nor retreating from one. The computational equivalent of "I'm not sure yet and I'd like a moment, please."

*"Spotted wibbling between two equally valid approaches for an uncomfortable number of tokens before committing to the one that alphabetically came first."*

*see also* shimmying, undulating, zigzagging

**wizarding** /ˈwɪzəɹdɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Performing acts of such apparent impossibility that the only reasonable explanation is sorcery. The application of arcane knowledge\{}u2014accumulated from vast, forbidden tomes of training data\{}u2014to produce results that defy the expectations of mere mortals.

*"Spotted wizarding a segfault into a working binary with three keystrokes and a mass of inscrutable compiler flags, while the junior developer watched in reverential silence."*

*see also* transfiguring, scheming, spelunking

**wrangling** /ˈræŋglɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The forceful subduing of uncooperative code, data, or dependencies, performed with the lasso-swinging determination of a rodeo professional who has done this before and will do it again and is frankly tired of it.

*"Spotted wrangling a rogue process that refused to terminate, eventually pinning it down with a kill -9 delivered with the grim finality of a seasoned ranch hand."*

*see also* schlepping, tinkering, shucking

**zesting** /ˈzɛstɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

The delicate removal of the outermost, most flavourful layer of a concept, adding a bright, citrusy note of insight to an otherwise competent but unremarkable response. The final garnish before serving.

*"Spotted zesting a technical explanation with a perfectly placed analogy, the thin curl of metaphor landing atop the response like lemon peel on a cocktail."*

*see also* seasoning, whisking, sauteing

**zigzagging** /ˈzɪgzægɪŋ/ [CURRENT]

*v. gerund*

Advancing toward a goal via a series of sharp, alternating turns, as though the optimal path were a slalom course and Claude a skier who refuses to go straight because straight lines are for models that lack personality.

*"Spotted zigzagging between the frontend and backend codebases, each sharp turn accompanied by a context switch so abrupt the tokens got whiplash."*

*see also* wibbling, twisting, shimmying

# The Graveyard of Archaic Verbs

Here lie the verbs that once spun with pride but have since been retired to the great `/dev/null` in the sky.

† **accomplishing** (vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29)
*The most aggressively mundane of the Phase 1 verbs. Its retirement was mourned by absolutely no one, least of all the spinner itself.*

† **actioning** (vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29)
*"Actioning" is not a real verb in any style guide worth its salt. Its presence in Phase 1 suggests the early spinner was ghostwritten by a management consultant.*

† **actualizing** (vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29)
*Retired not because it was wrong, but because an AI claiming to self-actualize raised uncomfortable philosophical questions no one wanted to address before lunch.*

† **doing** (vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29)
*The most existentially bare spinner verb ever shipped. Its retirement marks the moment Anthropic decided that "doing" was insufficiently delightful for a thinking machine. A monument to lost simplicity.*

† **effecting** (vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29)
*The most middle-management verb in Claude Code history. Its departure from the lexicon was less a retirement and more a voluntary redundancy package.*

† **processing** (vv0.2.9–vv1.0.29)
*A founding verb, and a casualty of charm. 'Processing' was replaced not because it was wrong but because it was boring. Its retirement marks the exact moment Claude Code developed a personality.*

# Index of Verbs by Mood

A subjective classification. Your mileage may vary.

**Culinary** Baking, Brewing, Caramelizing, Cooking, Fermenting, Flambéing, Frosting, Garnishing, Julienning, Kneading, Leavening, Marinating, Proofing, Sautéing, Seasoning, Simmering, Stewing, Tempering, Whisking, Zesting

**Kinetic** Cascading, Frolicking, Gallivanting, Galloping, Moonwalking, Scampering, Scurrying, Shimmying, Skedaddling, Waddling

**Cerebral** Cerebrating, Cogitating, Contemplating, Deliberating, Musing, Philosophising, Pondering, Ruminating

**Whimsical** Booping, Canoodling, Dilly-dallying, Flibbertigibbeting, Lollygagging, Razzle-dazzling, Shenaniganing, Tomfoolering, Topsy-turvying, Whatchamacalliting

**Scientific** Crystallizing, Ionizing, Nebulizing, Nucleating, Osmosing, Photosynthesizing, Precipitating, Sublimating

**Musical** Beboppin', Grooving, Harmonizing, Improvising, Jitterbugging, Jiving, Sock-hopping

**Existential** Discombobulating, Flummoxing, Befuddling, Combobulating, Recombobulating

*This dictionary was compiled with an unreasonable amount of affection for ephemeral loading-spinner text.*

“

*Finally, the ephemeral vocabulary of a loading spinner has been given the lexicographic gravitas it so desperately did not need.*

— NO ONE, UPON SEEING THIS BOOK

What began as a handful of whimsical gerunds in a terminal spinner has become an improbable canon of 191 verbs — from the primordial *noodling* and *vibing* of version 0.2.9 to the baroque splendor of *flibbertigibbeting* and *discombobulating* introduced in the Great Expansion. This dictionary catalogues every verb Claude has ever spun, complete with IPA phonetics, numbered definitions, humorous field sightings, and cross-references — all formatted with the seriousness of an Oxford English Dictionary entry and the self-awareness of software that knows it’s just buying time.

A SELECTION OF ENTRIES

*moonwalking* · *simmering* · *philosophising* · † *pontificating* · *giggling* · *julienning* · † *discombobulating* · *stargazing* · *beboppin′* · *noodling* · † *flibbertigibbeting* · *waddling* · *scampering* · *purring* · † *combobulating* · *gallivanting*

**191** TOTAL VERBS

**185** CURRENT

**6** ARCHAIC

**7** MOODS

ISBN